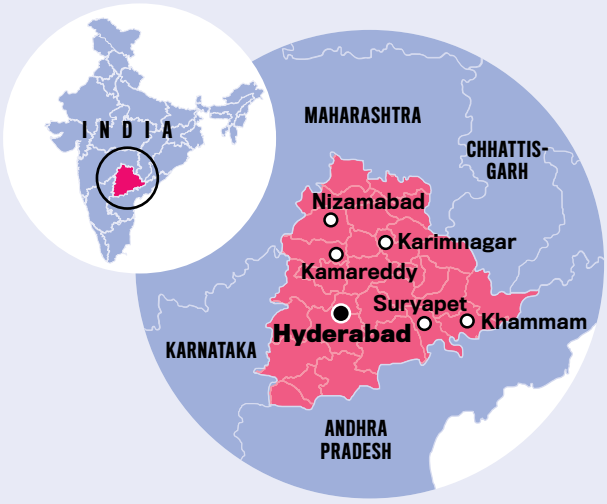
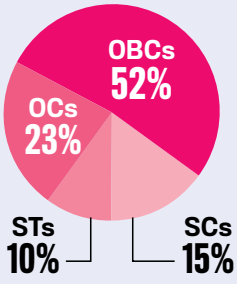


CASTE BREAK-UP



Other Castes (OC) include Reddy, Kamma, Brahmin, Vysya and Velama; **Other Backward Classes (OBC)** include Goud, Mudiraj, Yadav, Munnurkapu and Padmashali castes; **Scheduled Castes (SC)** include Malas and Madigas and **Scheduled Tribes (ST)** Lambadas, Gonds, Koyas, Chenchus

Source: Govt of Telangana

MAJOR WELFARE SCHEMES

RYTHU BANDHU

Crop investment support of Rs 5,000 an acre for a crop season for farmers since 2018

6.9 MN*
₹72,815 CR.#

**No. of beneficiaries in FY24; #Disbursement since FY19*

AASARA PENSION

Monthly support of Rs 2,000-4,000 for the day-to-day minimum needs and social security of the disadvantaged

4.4 MN*
₹54,989 CR.#

**No. of beneficiaries since 2014; #Expenditure*

MARRIAGE ASSISTANCE

SC/ST and minority families are being given Rs 100,116 for the marriage of a girl since 2014

KALYANA LAKSHMI

585,795*
₹5,339 CR.#

**No. of beneficiaries since FY17; #Expenditure*

SHAADI MUBARAK

393,552*
₹1,903 CR.#

**No. of beneficiaries from FY15 to Jan. 17, 2023; #Expenditure*

cent it did in 2014, the party won only 19 seats. The TRS, which netted 46.9 per cent of the votes, bagged 88 and the BJP, which had a vote share of nearly 7 per cent, won only one seat. Recent opinion polls suggest that the Congress may have narrowed that gap with the BRS significantly.

The Congress will, indeed, be a source of worry for KCR. The party had begun putting its strategy in place over a year ago, but the convincing victory in Karnataka has put wind in its sails. The Congress has now stationed the architect of that win—the ace poll strategist Sunil Kanugolu—in Telangana. It is relying on his constituency-wise assessments to tailor its campaign to dislodge contestants of rival parties. And while the high command was initially reluctant to accept defectors from other parties, they yielded once it was pointed out that the TRS and BJP had poached most of the Congress leaders. Convinced, the party has wooed and fielded as many as 30 defectors in this election.

What has also invigorated the Congress campaign is the feisty leadership of the 54-year-old A. Revanth Reddy, its Lok Sabha MP, who became president of the Telangana Pradesh Congress Committee (TPCC) in June 2021. He replaced N. Uttam Kumar Reddy who in 2016 had publicly vowed not to shave his beard till the Congress came to power only to end up having his bearded face become a symbol of the party's impotency. Revanth, on the other hand, is a street fighter with an acerbic tongue. Seen as aggressive, articulate, earthy and charismatic, he can give KCR as good as he gets. Revanth also has an old grudge against the Telangana CM, who had him arrested in 2015 after the state's Anti-Corruption Bureau charged him with bribing a nominated MLA. Revanth had to cool his heels in jail for over a month before he got bail.

WHAT HAS INVIGORATED THE CONGRESS CAMPAIGN IS THE FEISTY LEADERSHIP OF THE 54-YR-OLD A. REVANTH REDDY, WHO CAN GIVE AS GOOD AS HE GETS TO KCR

The Congress is also leveraging its 'guarantees' that saw it win in neighbouring Karnataka. If KCR is flaunting his welfare schemes, the Congress is countering it with six guarantees that Sonia Gandhi, chairperson, Congress Parliamentary Party, announced at a rally in Hyderabad in September. To begin with, there is Mahalakshmi, a monthly grant of Rs 2,500 for women, in an effort to woo them. Then there is free travel for them in state transport buses and gas cylinders for Rs 500. To counter KCR's popular Rythu Bandhu scheme, the Congress has promised an annual financial assistance of Rs 15,000 to farmers, Rs 5,000